resulting from the failed attempts to imitate its culture. Muslims now had two options. Some felt that the failure had stemmed from the abandonment of ancient traditions, of authentic Islamic civilization. The two main trends that emerged from this perception were Wahhabi fundamentalism, as disseminated by the Saudis, and Iranian-inspired Shiite fundamentalism. The other option was supported by embracers of modernity, who maintained that the failure had resulted from the fact that the Muslims had adopted only the superficial layers of Western civilization and not its deeper contents, and that consequently efforts should be made to implant Western values more fully. Throughout the Muslim world there are people who believe this, but the despotic regimes make it difficult for them to express their opinions openly.

Osama bin Laden represented an extreme expression of the first option. However—and here Lewis added a very interesting point— we cannot underestimate the importance of Arab oil. The huge profits accumulated by the Saudi rulers enabled them to develop extensive networks of schools that nurtured Wahhabi fundamentalism. It may be that had it not been for oil, this movement would have remained an insignificant phenomenon in a marginal country. According to this view, oil has been the Arabs' downfall, because it allowed the regimes to amass enormous amounts of money that strengthened their political and military power and to suppress any efforts toward democracy and freedom. It is no coincidence that the only Arab countries in which a civil society has developed are Morocco and Jordan, neither of which has any oil.

Responding to the question of whether America is hated in the Muslim world because of its support for Israel, Lewis pointed out that while its affinity with Israel obviously does not help America's popularity, the Middle East is not the only region in the world in which this great and rich empire is detested. It is hated mainly because it is so successful, and this resentment is exploited by local elements for their own purposes. For bin Laden, for example, the main problem was his country, Saudi Arabia, which he wanted to purge of the presence and influence of the infidels.

Westerners tend to ask the wrong question: "Why don't they love us?" The simple answer is that you cannot be wealthy, powerful, and successful and expect to be loved, especially when you haven't lost a fight in hundreds of years. The correct question to ask is: "Why have they stopped respecting us, or at least being afraid of us?" Muslim culture espouses the notion of the